

Nicholas (Nic) Jones

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Washington, D.C.
Active Top Secret Clearance

SUMMARY

Hands-on security engineer and published vulnerability researcher with 7+ years across offensive security, AWS and Azure cloud network security, and enterprise security. Lead T-Rex's information security program and a network security team for the U.S. Department of Education. Currently completing an M.S. in Information Security Engineering at SANS and expanding into AI red teaming through CTF competitions and projects.

EXPERIENCE

T-Rex Solutions, LLC (*Bethesda, MD - Remote*) Jun. 2019 – Present

- **Information Security Manager (Jan. 2024 – Present)**
 - Lead T-Rex's information security program, including strategy and security architecture
 - Led successful ISO 27001, NIST SP 800-171, and CMMC audits
 - Rolled out EDR, SIEM, and zero trust architecture across the T-Rex enterprise
 - Overhauled the vulnerability management program and established program metrics
 - Conduct incident response and run tabletop exercises with executives
 - Built an internal AI-powered SCORM course builder for company-wide security awareness training
 - Lead AI adoption for IT & Security, developing AI tools and reporting progress to company leadership
- **Cybersecurity Engineer (May 2020 – Dec. 2023)**
 - Conducted periodic penetration tests, managed network infrastructure, and developed incident response exercises
 - Led MITRE ATT&CK adoption and ISO 27001 preparation, and managed the information security intern
- **Cybersecurity Analyst (Aug. 2019 – May 2020)**
 - Led malicious email analysis and vulnerability & patch management
 - Performed cloud security architecture, security awareness training, and network monitoring
- **Cybersecurity Intern (Jun. 2019 – Aug. 2019)**
 - Re-architected the SIEM platform for security event logging and detection
 - Supported Splunk implementation and the development of security procedures, policies, compliance, and training

U.S. Department of Education (*Washington, D.C. - Remote, via T-Rex*) Sep. 2024 – Present

- **Network Security Manager (Apr. 2025 – Present)**
 - Manage a 5-person network and security team on the Department's cloud hosting contract
 - Led TIC 3.0 implementation and a full redesign of the AWS and Azure cloud networks
 - Secure traffic with Palo Alto VM-Series firewalls and public endpoints with AWS WAF, CloudFront, and Azure Front Door
- **Cloud Engineer (Sep. 2024 – Apr. 2025)**
 - Hands-on engineer on the team that migrated 20+ systems from a legacy hosting platform to AWS in 3 months

Palantir Technologies (*Washington, D.C. - Remote, via T-Rex*) Jun. 2022 – Dec. 2023

- **Data Engineer (Jun. 2022 – Dec. 2023)**
 - Built Palantir Foundry data pipelines for the Department of Energy's National Nuclear Security Administration (NNSA)
 - Developed ETL in Python, PySpark, and TypeScript to ingest, clean, and normalize critical government data

Synack Red Team (*Freelance*) May 2022 – Aug. 2024

- **Security Researcher (May 2022 – Aug. 2024)**
 - Tested web, host, and mobile targets and reported security vulnerabilities for Synack's clients
 - Selected for Synack's vetted researcher program through technical assessments and interviews

Early Career

Applications Tester & Developer – Mobius Intelligent Systems (<i>Laurel, MD - Remote</i>)	May 2019 – Sep. 2019
SOC Analyst/Engineer – Capitol Technology University Cyber Lab (<i>Laurel, MD</i>)	Mar. 2019 – Sep. 2019
Data Technician – ADNET Systems, Inc. (<i>NASA GSFC, Greenbelt, MD</i>)	Dec. 2018 – May 2019
IT Intern – CSRA, Inc. (<i>Falls Church, VA</i>)	Dec. 2017 – Jan. 2018

EDUCATION

Master of Science in Information Security Engineering – SANS Technology Institute Oct. 2024 – May 2027

- 4.0 GPA, National Cyber League (NCL) Scholarship Winner (Fall 2024 & Spring 2025)

Master of Science in Cybersecurity – Wilmington University Aug. 2021 – Aug. 2023

- 4.0 GPA, Epsilon Pi Tau Honor Society

Bachelor of Science in Cyber & Information Security – Capitol Technology University Aug. 2016 – May 2020

- 3.8 GPA, Dean's List (x4), Magna Cum Laude, Upsilon Pi Epsilon Honor Society

CERTIFICATIONS

Information Security & Technology Certifications

GIAC Penetration Tester (GPEN)	2026 – 2030
GIAC Certified Intrusion Analyst (GCIA)	2026 – 2030
SANS Security Awareness Professional (SSAP)	2025 – 2029
GIAC Defensible Security Architecture (GDSA)	2025 – 2029
GIAC Strategic Planning & Leadership (GSTRT)	2025 – 2029
GIAC Certified Incident Handler (GCIH)	2025 – 2029
GIAC Security Essentials (GSEC)	2024 – 2028
ISC2 CISSP	2024 – 2027
OSCP	2021 – ∞
CEH	2020 – 2026
CompTIA CySA+, Security+, Network+, A+, ITF+	2017 – 2028

Cloud & Development Certifications

GitHub Actions	2024 – 2027
GitHub Foundations	2024 – 2027
ISACA CMMI Associate	2024 – 2027
AWS Certified Solutions Architect Professional	2023 – 2029
AWS Certified Security Specialty	2022 – 2025
AWS Certified Solutions Architect Associate	2020 – 2029
Azure Security Engineer Associate (AZ-500)	2020 – 2027
AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner	2019 – 2029
ITIL v4 Foundation	2019 – ∞

VULNERABILITY RESEARCH & PROJECTS

PUBLISHED CVES

CVE-2026-62183 – Apache Syncope: User Self-Service Privilege Escalation	Jul. 2026
CVE-2024-43404 – MEGABOT: Remote Code Execution	Aug. 2024

PROJECTS

UNICORD – Security research organization developing proof-of-concept exploits for known CVEs	May 2022 – Present
• CVE-2025-29927: Next.js Middleware Authorization Bypass · CVE-2022-25765: pdfkit Command Injection · CVE-2021-22204: ExifTool Arbitrary Code Execution · CVE-2020-5844: Pandora FMS Remote Code Execution · CVE-2021-3560: Polkit Local Privilege Escalation	
HAMRadioWallet.com – App that adds FCC amateur radio licenses to Apple Wallet and Google Wallet	Jul. 2024 – Sep. 2024
• Built with Next.js and TypeScript · Integrated with Apple Wallet and Google Wallet APIs · Deployed with SST	
GitHub Discord Bot – Serverless bot that subscribes Discord channels to GitHub repository events	Jan. 2024 – Jun. 2024
• Built with AWS Lambda and AWS SQS · Integrated GitHub Webhooks and Discord APIs · Serverless architecture for scalability	

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Information Security Engineering:** SIEMs, Splunk, Sentinel, Penetration Testing, Incident Response, Vulnerability Research, EDR, Zero Trust, Vulnerability Management
- **Governance & Compliance:** ISO 27001, NIST SP 800-171, CMMC, TIC 3.0, Tabletop Exercises
- **AI Security & Engineering:** AI Red Teaming, Prompt Injection, AI Agent Security, Internal AI Product Development
- **Cloud Network Security:** AWS VPC, Transit Gateway, Azure VNet, Azure Firewall, NSGs, Palo Alto VM-Series, Hub-and-Spoke Architecture, AWS WAF, CloudFront, Route 53, Azure Front Door
- **Cloud Architecture & Engineering:** AWS, Azure, Serverless Technologies, AWS CDK, Multi-account Architectures
- **Software Development:** Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, PySpark, PHP, MySQL
- **DevSecOps:** CI/CD, GitHub Workflows, Infrastructure as Code

AWARDS & WINS

huntr "Inside Job" AI Red Teaming Challenge – 1st Place Overall	2026
SANS Core NetWars Tournament @ SANSFIRE – 1st Place, Solo	2025 & 2026
SANS Defense NetWars Tournament @ SANSFIRE – 1st Place, Team Game	2026
SANS DFIR NetWars Tournament @ SANS Security West – 1st Place, Team Game	2026
SANS Core NetWars Tournament @ SANS Security West – 1st Place, Team Game	2026
National Cyber League (NCL) Spring 2026 Team Game – 1st Place, Experienced Students Bracket	2026
SANS NetWars Tournament of Champions @ Cyber Defense Initiative – 5th Place, Solo	2025
National Cyber League (NCL) Fall 2025 Team Game – 3rd Place, Experienced Students Bracket	2025
National Cyber League (NCL) Spring 2025 Team Game – 4th Place, Experienced Students Bracket	2025
Parsons Cyber CTF – 1st Place (2019), 2nd Place (2024 x2), 3rd Place (2019)	2019 & 2024
CT Cubed CTF @ DEFCON – 1st Place	2023
BSides Charm Exabeam CTF – 1st Place	2023
Maryland Cyber Challenge – 3rd Place	2019
Boy Scouts of America Eagle Scout Award – 3 additional palms	2014